

RE: subpoena of First Amendment Foundation

From: James B. Lake (jlake@tlolawfirm.com)
To: cahanson77@yahoo.com; truthoverchaos@outlook.com
Date: Friday, May 22, 2026 at 09:18 PM EDT

Thank you for your cooperation.

Jim Lake
jlake@tlolawfirm.com
Thomas & LoCicero PL
813.984.3063

From: James B. Lake
Sent: Friday, May 22, 2026 3:57 PM
To: 'cahanson77@yahoo.com' <cahanson77@yahoo.com>; Christopher A Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>
Subject: RE: subpoena of First Amendment Foundation

Mr. Hanson:

At any time between January 1, 2025 and May 17, 2026, did the First Amendment Foundation, Inc., or any of its current or former employees, directors, officers, board members, agents, volunteers, legal team, or any other representative, ever had or received — directly or indirectly, and in any form (in person, by telephone, voicemail, email, text or other electronic message, social media including direct messages, or any other medium) — any communication with any third party or parties (other than myself) that references, mentions, or relates to me, my litigation, my public records disputes, and/or whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my matters?

_____yes no___X___

The Foundation is not agreeing to provide any further information and specifically reserves the right to object to any future demand or subpoena; to move to quash any such subpoena; or to move for a protective order concerning any future subpoena.

Thank you.

Jim
jlake@tlolawfirm.com
Thom
813.984

From [REDACTED] <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent PM
To: J firm.com>; Christopher A Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>
Subj mendment Foundation

Given the most recent confusion, I need you to clarify by answering below on behalf of your client for this specific question. You can answer below which is blank now or just cut and paste the Q and A answer in your own email.

At any time between January 1, 2025 and May 17, 2026, did the First Amendment Foundation, Inc., or any of its current or former employees, directors, officers, board members, agents, volunteers, legal team, or any other representative, ever had or received — directly or indirectly, and in any form (in person, by telephone, voicemail, email, text or other electronic message, social media including direct messages, or any other medium) — any communication with any third party or parties (other than myself) that references, mentions, or relates to me, my litigation, my public records disputes, and/or whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my matters?

_____yes no_____

Upon your unequivocal written confirmation of the foregoing, I will withdraw the subpoena as to Mr. Blocks appearance at the May 29 hearing. I do not agree that this ends my pursuit of information from FAF either way. Thank you.

Chris

Sent from Yahoo Mail for iPhone

On Friday, May 22, 2026, 3:31 PM, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

So I ask that you clarify by answering below on behalf of your client for this specific question: You can answer in my email below which is blank now or just cut and paste the Q and A answer in your own email. At any time from January 1, 2025 to the present, excluding only the First Amendments Foundations communications with myself and your firm, has the First Amendment Foundation, Inc., or any of its current or former employees, directors, officers, board members, agents, volunteers, legal team, or any other representative, ever had or received — directly or indirectly, and in any form (in person, by telephone, voicemail, email, text or other electronic message, social media including direct messages, or any other medium) — any communication with any third party or parties that references, mentions, or relates to me, my litigation, my public records disputes, or whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my matters? _____yes no_____ Upon your unequivocal written confirmation of the foregoing, I will withdraw the subpoena as to Mr. Blocks appearance at the May 29 hearing.

Sent from Yahoo Mail for iPhone

On Friday, May 22, 2026, 3:31 PM, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

Correction – May 18, 2026.

Thank you.

Jim Lake

jlake@tlolawfirm.com

Thomas & LoCicero PL

813.984.3063

From: James B. Lake

Sent: Friday, May 22, 2026 3:27 PM

To: 'cahanson77@yahoo.com' <cahanson77@yahoo.com>; Christopher A Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>

Subject: RE: subpoena of First Amendment Foundation

Mr. Hanson:

My message says May 18, 2025, the date the subpoena was served.

Thank you.

Jim

jlake@tlolawfirm.com

Thom

813.984

From [REDACTED] <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent PM
To: C verchaos@outlook.com; James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com>
Subj mendment Foundation

Do you want to correct something in there? May 28, 2025?? If you're only certifying no conferences before May 28, 2025, and I am not withdrawing the subpoena. Communications after May 28, 2025 may be very relevant to my situation.

On Friday, May 22, 2026 at 03:12:50 PM EDT, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

Mr. Hanson:

I inadvertently included the privilege header. Please disregard that.

Regarding the substance of your message, I do not consider myself a "third party" to the Foundation, because I am an attorney representing the Foundation in response to your subpoena. As my prior message explained, discussion of this matter reached beyond Mr. Block and Ms. Nzekwesi only after you sent a subpoena to the Foundation's registered agent. That subpoena escalated this matter to discussion among the Foundation's directors and private attorneys, principally me, concerning a legal response. The Foundation's communications with counsel, of course, are privileged.

At no time from January 1, 2025 to the present has the First Amendment Foundation, Inc., or any of its current or former employees, directors, officers, board members, agents, volunteers, legal team, or any other representative, ever had or received — directly or indirectly, and in any form (in person, by telephone, voicemail, email, text or other electronic message, social media including direct messages, or any other medium) — any communication with any third party or parties that references, mentions, or relates to you, your litigation, your public records disputes, or whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my matters, except consultation since May 18, 2025, with private counsel to seek legal advice and representation concerning the subpoena.

We will not be providing any more information. You have no basis for seeking discovery from the Foundation. If the subpoena is not withdrawn by 5 p.m. today, we will proceed with a motion to quash or for protective order.

Thank you.

Jim

jlake@

Thom

813.984

From [REDACTED] <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent PM
To: C verchaos@outlook.com; James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com>
Subj mendment Foundation

Mr. Lake,

As a threshold matter, I do not regard any of our correspondence as privileged or confidential, and I do not accept that designation on your message. We are adverse parties; no attorney-client relationship exists between us, and nothing you send me is privileged as to me. I reserve the right to use this correspondence, including by filing it with the Court or releasing it publicly. Sunlight is precisely what this matter needs. If there is some basis for confidentiality here, please explain it.

I appreciate that your latest message is broader than the earlier undefined, "about your requests" formulation that you limited to the 2 employees. But your message opens by defining "requests" on your own terms now, introducing ambiguity as to the time frame and subject matter on which you are confirming. Furthermore, I know that the First Amendment Foundation thru its employees or agents eventually had communications with you and your office related to the subpoena I had served this week. The statement in your email is inconsistent with that obvious fact. I'm not accusing you of any intent to mislead, but the point is that I need confirmation on this without qualification or ambiguity.

So I ask that you clarify by answering below on behalf of your client for this specific question: You can answer in my email below which is blank now or just cut and paste the Q and A answer in your own email.

At any time from January 1, 2025 to the present, **excluding only** the First Amendment's Foundation's communications with myself and your firm, has the First Amendment Foundation, Inc., or any of its current or former employees, directors, officers, board members, agents, volunteers, legal team, or any other representative, ever had or received — directly or indirectly, and in any form (in person, by telephone, voicemail, email, text or other electronic message, social media including direct messages, or any other medium) — any communication with any third party or parties that references, mentions, or relates to me, my litigation, my public records disputes, or whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my matters?

_____yes no_____

Upon your unequivocal written confirmation of the foregoing, I will withdraw the subpoena as to Mr. Block's appearance at the May 29 hearing.

Independent of that confirmation, and because I have specific reason to believe responsive communications exist, I reiterate my preservation request: please ensure that the Foundation and all of the individuals above preserve all responsive records, and all phones, computers, servers, and other devices containing them, from January 1, 2025 forward. My willingness to resolve Mr. Block's appearance rests in reliance on your representation; if that representation later proves incomplete or inaccurate, I reserve all rights, including to re-subpoena and to seek appropriate relief.

Separately — I continue to request the documents responsive to the subpoena, including the internal communications Mr. Block has already acknowledged ("there have been internal communications within FAF about your inquiry and the materials you submitted"). I am content to receive those with any necessary redactions although I'm not sure what would be privileged in terms comments on my case. I may need to schedule a deposition or hearing attendance in the future depending on how the records production process goes.

I have repeatedly offered reasonable paths to resolve this without motion practice, and this message offers another. I do not accept the premise that a good-faith subpoena, paired with these accommodations, exposes me to a fee award; I would prefer we not litigate that and instead close this out on the simple confirmation above.

Respectfully,

Christopher Hanson
FL Bar #44094
727-409-5738

On Friday, May 22, 2026 at 11:28:09 AM EDT, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

PRIVILEGED AND CONFIDENTIAL:
ATTORNEY-CLIENT COMMUNICATION

Mr. Hanson:

The word "requests" in my May 21 message referred to your calls and email messages to the Foundation seeking assistance concerning your litigation and whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in that litigation.

No one associated with the Foundation — including its employees, directors, board members, legal team, and any other representatives — has or received, at any time, any communication with any third party (including but not limited to any public official, government agency, or member of the media) concerning you, your litigation, or your public records disputes.

Please confirm by 5 p.m. today that your subpoena is withdrawn.

Thank you.

Jim
jlake@
Thom
813.984

From [REDACTED] <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent AM
To: C verchaos@outlook.com>; James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com>
Subj mendment Foundation

Mr. La

Thank you for . My original
email was my

Especially in t 's concerning that
FAF is not mo requested the AG
investigate tha [REDACTED] explanation for the
course of even

However, I wa fered remote
appearance by f the document

portion entirely — by producing the communications I've requested. These shouldn't be huge files. I have reason to believe that there were 2 individuals that communicated with FAF. Locating those and sending them should take less time that it took you to draft the email below. I am trying to minimize any burden, not impose one.

It's obvious that your email is carefully drafted, much like Mr. Block's communications with me. You create an illusory response to my question and concerns, by significantly limiting your confirmation of what FAF has and did.

I asked whether anyone associated with the Foundation — *"staff, legal team, board members, or any other representative"* — has had *"any communication about me or my cases in litigation with any third party whatsoever."* Your response narrowed that in two specific ways:

1) **Subject.** You stated the two employees did not communicate *"about your requests,"* and did not discuss *"your requests"* with the Bar, the Attorney General's Office, any court, or any third party.

- My concern is not limited to communications about my "requests." In fact, I'm not even sure what you mean by my "requests" and the communications I'm concerned about were in direct opposition to my interests.

-The critical concern here is whether any third party communicated with the Foundation **about me, about my litigation, or about whether the Foundation should assist or decline involvement in my case.** A communication of that kind does not fall under any *"about [my] requests"* category. I have reason to believe such communications exist and both you and Mr. Block have carefully avoided confirming that they do not.

2) **Personnel and timing.** Your denial is scoped to *"the two of them"* — the two employees. Nothing in my correspondence limited the question to those 2 individuals.

- Again, you avoid the critical concern in your correspondence - whether there were ever any communications about me or my litigation and public records disputes.

-You addressed the Foundation's directors only as to discussions that occurred *"after [I] sent a subpoena,"* concerning the legal response. That leaves unaddressed whether any **director, board member, or other representative had or received any communication from a third party about me or my matter at an earlier time.**

The failures to answer the critical question in your email mirror Mr. Block's earlier responses. Neither of you have ever specifically denied the existence of any relevant communications.

As to my preservation request, Mr. Block committed only to retain records *"in the ordinary course,"* not to a litigation hold. I have now asked the same straightforward question several times and have not received a complete, unqualified answer covering all personnel and all communications concerning me or my litigation.

I must reiterate. I have reason to believe that relevant communications exist. I am going to pursue them in every manner possible for as long as it takes. I again reiterate my request to FAF's team to preserve all phones, computers, servers, and other devices that contain any communications from 1-1-25 forward for electronic discovery if that becomes necessary.

THE SIMPLE RESOLUTION TO ALL OF THIS:

Confirmation of no relevant communications, **without qualification**, will resolve the subpoena for attendance at the May 29 hearing.

Did anyone associated with the Florida First Amendment Foundation — including its employees, directors, board members, legal team, and any other representatives — have or receive, at any time, any communication with any third party (including but not limited to any public official, government agency, or member of the media) concerning me, my litigation, and/or my public records disputes?

This is a simple question in service of precisely what FAF's mission statement purports to advance. Opposing me and refusing to cooperate with these simple requests suggests that FAF is actually working against what its mission statement is, which brings up its own set of concerns we can address if necessary.

I would much rather resolve this cooperatively than through motion practice and lawsuits, and I have offered several ways to do exactly that. Please let me know the Foundation's position.

Respectfully,

Christopher Hanson
FL Bar #44094
727-409-5738

On Thursday, May 21, 2026 at 05:10:47 PM EDT, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

Mr. Hanson:

Your condolences to Mr. Block are appreciated. But kind words ring hollow given your continued insistence that the First Amendment Foundation provide documents and testimony in this matter.

The Foundation has two employees – Grace Nzekwesi, who works for the Foundation approximately six hours each week, and Mr. Block. The two of them did not communicate with anyone else about your requests. They did not discuss your requests with The Florida Bar, the Attorney General's Office, any court, or any other third party. Any knowledge the Foundation has about your cases came from you. In fact, discussion of this matter reached beyond Mr. Block and Ms. Nzekwesi only after you sent a subpoena to the Foundation's registered agent. That subpoena escalated this matter to discussion among the Foundation's directors and private attorneys, principally me, concerning a legal response. The Foundation's communications with its counsel, of course, are privileged.

Although the Foundation has an interest in open government generally, the Foundation has no obligation to address every such issue or to provide assistance to every requester. Judicial branch records are not the Foundation's focus. Now that the Foundation has evaluated your requests, the Foundation has come to the conclusion that its scarce resources are better devoted to other matters. The Foundation is not required to document for you its decision-making process.

For all of these reasons, and because you have conceded that any testimony from Mr. Block on legal issues would likely be inadmissible, there is no reason to divert the Foundation's staff time or resources to providing testimony or to producing documents.

Your message states, "I'm not the problem here." Your subpoena, however, is the problem. You used your authority as a litigant to demand a nonprofit organization provide records and testimony at a hearing across the state in a matter that does not involve that organization. The Foundation has nothing to add concerning this matter. "One who could shed no light on the issues of a case, civil or criminal, did not have to testify at deposition or trial." *Kridos v. Vinskus*, 483 So. 2d 727, 731 (Fla. 4th DCA 1985) (witness's certiorari petition granted). As a Florida attorney, you know that the civil and family law rules *mandate* an award of expenses when a protective order is granted, which may include attorneys' fees. *See* Fla. Fam. L. R. P. 12.280(d) & 12.380(a)(4). Your potential liability for the Foundation's attorneys' fees is a situation of your own making.

Please confirm by 5 p.m. on May 22, 2026, that your subpoena is withdrawn. Otherwise, we will proceed with a motion to quash or for protective order and will present that to Judge Felix at the earliest opportunity.

Thank you.

Jim

jlake@
Thom
813.984

From [REDACTED] <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent 12 AM
To: J firm.com>; Christopher A Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>
Subj mendment Foundation

Good

I regret that I have to bother anyone with all of this and I certainly

blem in the Judiciary right in line with what FAF seeks to
ompliance and misconduct involved directly threatens the

children. It is a very disturbing set of facts and I hope that you,
public statements from Block and FAF.

s to protect my kids from this growing corruption problem. I
regard the Foundation as an ally, not an adversary. I know better than most how important its work is. My goal here is cooperation and I'll work with you and Mr. Block to minimize inconvenience.

The testimony I seek from Mr. Block is not on general legal issues. I have reason to believe that FAF has relevant communications and materials important to the issues in my particular facts. Mr. Block indicated that there were at least internal communications about my cases. I ask that Mr. Block produce those with any necessary redactions. Mr. Block never formally answered my questions about whether he or any person associated with FAF had any communications about me or my cases with anyone outside the organization other than myself.

Will FAF and Mr. Block confirm unequivocally and in writing, that no one associated with it (staff, legal team, board members, or any other representative) has had any communication about me or my cases in litigation with any third party whatsoever? I expect that will substantially narrow or eliminate the need for Mr. Block's testimony if you all confirm that and send any communications (internal and any external that exist).

The Office of the Attorney General represents the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit against me in some of the related public-records litigation. The Attorney General's office and the Foundation are closely aligned — including as co-publishers of the Government-in-the-Sunshine Manual. I am not assuming anything improper; I simply want a clean, complete answer, and you are well positioned to give me one. I've objected to the AG's involvement all along as I was pleading with them to investigate the 13th Circuit over a year ago. Have there been any communications between FAF and the Florida AG's office about any of the litigation involving my cases?

On the nature of the testimony. To be clear about what I am — and am not — seeking: I do not ask Mr. Block to offer any opinion on a question of law, and I agree such testimony would likely be inadmissible. I seek only facts within the Foundation's and specifically Block's knowledge — what they were told, by whom, and what records or communications they may hold. The existence of particular conduct, and who communicated with whom, are questions of *fact*, not questions of *law*; *Lee Cnty. v. Barnett Banks* addresses only the latter and is therefore inapposite to the factual testimony I seek.

On documents. There is an equally simple resolution. The Foundation can either (a) produce the internal communications Mr. Block has already acknowledged — "*there have been internal communications within FAF about your inquiry and the materials you submitted*" — together with any other records responsive to Schedule A. If you think Schedule A on the subpoena is too broad, I'm happy to discuss any ideas to narrow it to documents referencing me or the listed matters and the Foundation's communications about them.

On scheduling and burden. The subpoena already anticipated a remote Zoom appearance, and I am happy to accommodate Mr. Block fully. I want to cooperate and minimize inconvenience. Perhaps a brief deposition in lieu of hearing appearance? Whatever is least disruptive for him, particularly given the difficult family circumstances you describe.

With that accommodation, I don't see a genuine burden, and I would much rather work this out together than litigate it. Given FAF's role and the facts of this case, I hope that Mr. Block will cooperate at least at a mutually convenient time to provide testimony that may help ensure the constitution prevails and my children are protected from govt overreach. It is

disappointing to see immediate threats of attorney fee litigation especially given the facts and history here. I'm not the problem here. I'm suffering precisely the problem FAF purports to fight.

Fighting me and this subpoena actually supports FL institutions concealing public records even when it directly harms citizens including Florida children. I'm sure that is not Mr. Block's intent. I want to make it as convenient as possible for him to comply.

Please let me know whether the Foundation will provide the written communications confirmations described above, and which accommodation works best for testimony. If it's more convenient for Mr. Block to attend a deposition, please let me know that and when he will become available. I will need to let the court know about that soon to ensure the testimony will be considered on these important child welfare issues

your cooperation and I look forward to hearing from you,

nson

y, May 20, 2026 at 05:47:47 PM EDT, James B. Lake <jlake@tlolawfirm.com> wrote:

Mr. Hanson:

I represent the First Amendment Foundation in connection with your subpoena addressed to Bobby Block. The Foundation objects to the subpoena. I write in an attempt to confer with you about the subpoena before filing a motion to quash or for protective order.

Testimony from Mr. Block will add nothing to the issues before the Court. The Foundation has no involvement in your litigation or the particular issues listed in the notice of hearing. The Foundation has no knowledge of the underlying facts, and its current staff has no expertise concerning access to judicial branch proceedings or records. Moreover, even if the Foundation had such expertise, testimony on legal issues would be inappropriate. *See Lee Cnty. v. Barnett Banks, Inc.*, 711 So. 2d 34, 34 (Fla. 2d DCA 1997) ("Expert testimony is not admissible concerning a question of law."), *approved sub nom. Pierpont v. Lee Cnty.*, 710 So. 2d 958 (Fla. 1998).

Finally, as a practical matter, Mr. Block will be in Ohio on May 29 visiting his recently widowed mother-in-law, so he is not available on that date to testify in person or via videoconference. And requiring him at any time to travel to Tampa to testify in your case would impose an undue burden.

For all of these reasons, please confirm that your subpoena is withdrawn, and that Mr. Block need not appear in response to it. Otherwise, please let us know whether you will oppose a motion to quash the subpoena or for a protective order. If such a motion is necessary, the Foundation will be entitled to an award of attorneys' fees. *See Fla. Fam. L. R. P. 12.280(d) & 12.380(a)(4).*

Please let me know your position.

Thank you.

t

Thomas



Litigation

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